

# Finger on the Digital Pulse

As the world's economies, enterprises and governments are digitising rapidly, India finds itself looking at a world full of opportunities. It is India's Techade



**POST-COVID-19, INDIA** is beginning to take big steps. It has not only discovered confidence in terms of dealing with adversities and challenges but has come out stronger on the other side of the storm. India finds itself as the fastest-growing economy, having delivered 2.1 billion vaccines manufactured in India, having received the highest amount of FDI and having created an innovation ecosystem that is the third largest in the world. India in 2023 is an India with reimagined ambitions for itself. So, this idea and vision of New India which was spoken about even pre-Covid-19, is becoming real in the time that we live in. As the world's economies, enterprises and governments are digitising rapidly, India finds itself looking at a world full of opportunities. There is a phrase in warfare, amongst fighter pilots, about a 'target-rich environment' and this is an 'opportunity-rich environment' for India and India's tech ecosystem. This is fuelling the confidence in the rei-



BY RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR

imagined ambitions going forward.

Our aim is to move from being a consumer of tech to becoming an architect and producer of tech, and achieve the \$1-trillion digital economy goal, including \$300 billion in electronics manufacturing by 2025-26. The most important element is that for the first time, we have a political leadership describing the coming years as India's Techade—a decade full of technological progress. This entire Techade and the economic activity will be built by young Indians. In the past when we looked at the economy, it was always about Tata or Birla, or a few big firms. But when the PM talks about the India Techade, he

is referring to a digital economy that will be built by young talent building their first firms. This is a significant departure from almost 60-65 years of a known economic model that India operated under. So that's one significant element of what will drive where we are going to be in 2047.

It was just a few years ago when India was described as a country that was very strong in IT and ITeS. We had a few large companies that created jobs and a large footprint in terms of clients and customers all over the world. But we were a unidimensional digital economy for many years.

While the IT and ITeS part of the economy continues to grow, we now have a digital innovation economy that is growing at a robust rate. It attracted the highest ever FDI and has the third-highest number of unicorns and start-ups in the world. Besides, 5G, electronics manufacturing, micro-electronics and semiconductor manufacturing will also be a significant part of the digital economy.

Looking further, our innovation ecosystem is creating a totally awe-inspiring opportunity in the AI and ML space. All of this and the fact that the internet is poised to lead to Web 3.0 creates another opportunity for us. An important footnote of this is that we have now evolved from being the back offices of the world and consumers of technology to confidently striding to the front office, and even to occupying leadership roles. We want to become architects, produc-